

Mitigating Insider Threats

Estimated time needed: 5 minutes

Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Define insider threat detection and threat mitigation programs
- Discuss ways to implement threat mitigation program

Introduction

With the rise in cyber threats, organizations are now investing in analyzing threats and threat mitigation programs designed to help in taking preventive actions before a user with privileged access or knowledge about the organizational systems makes an error or engages in harmful behavior. The goal of insider threat detection is to protect from data breaches, financial frauds, and theft of any intellectual property that can be fatal to the organization's overall security.

Threat mitigation program

Once the threat is identified, the next step is to use strategies, tools, and workflows to prevent them, which come under the threat mitigation program. Several essential factors contribute to the success of such a program, applicable to organizations of any size and level of maturity. They include the following steps.

1. Know your employees:

- Engage with employees regularly and understand their needs.
- Analyze new hires thoroughly to ensure they align with organizational values and goals.
- Implement continuous accountability processes within a protective culture.
- Prioritize regular awareness programs, education, and training to impart knowledge on risks and how to mitigate them.
- Address social engineering issues, policy noncompliance, and negligence through preventive education.

2. Identify and prioritize assets and risks by:

- Analyze the most valued assets of your organization.
- Identify potential risks that could damage organizational assets.
- Map out asset locations and determine personnel with access to them to classify and mitigate risks.

3. Establish a proven operational approach by:

- Implement a systematic approach, such as Detect, Identify, Assess, and Manage.
- Integrate the systematic approach into existing security protocols to enable threat detection and identification.
- Build a multidisciplinary team involving organization leaders, HR, IT, legal, and security.
- Gather and investigate threats, assess and categorize risks, and employ management strategies to mitigate threats.
- Use a combination of proactive measures to protect assets and reduce risks, ensuring overall organizational safety.

4. Consider additional measures, such as:

- Establish a safe environment for organizational safety and security.
- Control threats with clear policies.
- Detect and identify at-risk individuals or behaviors.
- Assess threats comprehensively.
- Manage and neutralize threats before they escalate to violence, sabotage, espionage, or theft.

Summary

In this reading, you learned that:

- Insider threat detection and threat mitigation programs are designed for effective risk management.
- Threat mitigation programs involve organizations knowing their employees, identifying and prioritizing assets, and establishing a proven operational approach.
- Additional measures of threat mitigation include creating a safe environment and designing clear policies.

Author(s)

Dee Dee Colette



Skills Network